



ShabbaTTogether

Inclusive Havdalah Program

Goals:

To bring your community together for Havdalah highlighting inclusion

Target Audience:

Jewish community including synagogues and Jewish agencies/schools

Time:

Approximately 1-2 hours

Medium:

Virtual or In-person.

Note to Facilitator:

Hosting a community Havdalah during February, Jewish Disability Awareness and Inclusion Month in honor of ShabbaTTogether is a meaningful way to bring your community together to highlight the important topics of disability inclusion and mental wellness.

Hosting a Community Havdalah ceremony with a short film or movie, snacks, activities and meaningful content will draw people with and without disabilities together as one community. Use this as a collaborative opportunity.

Partner with Federation, the JCC, other Jewish organizations and synagogues to co-sponsor the ShabbaTTogether Havdalah and evening program.

Invite the entire Jewish Community! This is an inclusive event, not only an event for people with disabilities.

Invite families with children, teens, and adults with disabilities and mental health conditions, seniors, people who live in group homes, and Jewish residences.

[CLICK HERE TO EDIT YOUR FLYER.](#)

Shabba**T**ogether Havdalah Ideas

Begin the Havdalah ceremony with an introduction that reflects the spirit of inclusion:

Ki Ner Hashem Nishmat Adam

Havdalah is most often associated with the flame of “*boreh meorei ha’aish* - He who creates the lights of fire.” Much like the flame strives ever upward, so too does man persevere to rise in both the physical and spiritual realms. Although the Havdalah service represents separation of the holy Shabbat that is passing and the upcoming week ahead, Havdalah is truly about unity. For the Havdalah service we need to have two intertwined wicks to light and merit the blessing. It has been brought down that the reason for this is that as we embark upon the new week, with its mundane concerns and pressures, we always remember that we are not alone in this world. We are mindful as we begin our week to remain connected to the G-dly soul (neshama) that burns brightly inside each of us, and it is that same unifying G-dly spark inside us all that connects us to the *neshamot* around us, our “brother souls.” Only then can we strive upwards and reach beyond our own expectations. On Shabbat, with its more relaxed ambiance, it is easier to focus on family, guests, and others, yet the Havdalah candle and its flame remind us that during our busy week we must also make space for others. Only then can we be complete.

[Click Here for Community
Pledge Handout](#)

This can also be printed and given out to each person with their [DIY Havdalah Kit](#) if you want to order them in advance.

Musical Havdalah

Create a musical havdalah ceremony to begin the program and include people with disabilities as part of the singers or playing instruments if possible.

Light Dinner or Dessert Reception

Great opportunity to highlight food allergies as part of an inclusive environment! Common food sensitivities include: dairy, gluten, eggs, tree nuts, and soy.

- Offer options such as gluten-free pizzas, salads and desserts. Serve fruit and veggies. Many kosher gluten free recipes can be found online.
- Post a sign or [Click Here to print table tents with allergy friendly labels so people](#) who have food sensitivities can know which foods are safe and which to avoid. For example:
 - Nut Free
 - Egg Free
 - Gluten Free
 - Contains Tree Nuts
 - Nut Free
 - Dairy Free

Program Ideas Following Havdalah

Braid Your Own [Havdalah Candle Kit](#)

This is a great craft project for your program. It's perfect for all ages, families and individuals. Weaving the strands together is symbolic of how every person is part of the Jewish community and if one person is missing, our community is not complete. [Click here to download](#) the instruction sheet to give out with your kits.

Inclusion Quilt

Make a quilt using different fabrics, colors, and textures. Give everyone one or two fabric squares. Divide into pairs and have them put their pieces together, stapling or taping the pieces. Bring all these pieces together to form one large quilt. Have several people be the "artisans," sewing, stapling or taping the pieces together. Talk about how the quilt came together and how each unique square enhances the beauty of the collective whole and makes

it complete - just like the people in our communities. [You can also purchase an easy, no sew option here.](#)

Guest Speakers or Panel Presentation

Invite a speaker from Jewish Family Services, NAMI, The Arc, or campus disability services to talk about what they can do to support someone with a disability or mental health condition.

Convene a panel discussion to include a community member who has a disability, a family member, and a professional from a disability or mental health agency.

Movie Night

There are many fine short films, documentaries, and stories that address different aspects of disability and mental health. For a complete listing, check the [JDAIM 2021 Program Guide](#). Host a screening in partnership with your local Jewish organizations.

A few movie options are listed below:

- **[JEM](#) - A Reflection of God: *The Rebbe's transformational approach in seeing possibility within every individual.***
 - Created in collaboration between the Ruderman Chabad Inclusion Initiative and Jewish Educational Media, a new short documentary highlighting the Lubavitcher Rebbe's views of *inclusion*, long before that word was ever coined.
- **The Interviewer - 12 min**
 - Thomas Howell gets more than he bargained for in an interview at a prestigious law firm. An insult about his tie, a rendition of Harry Potter, and the chance to change the lives of a father and son. This 12 minute film has won 30 international awards and has been screened at over 40 international film festivals. [The Interviewer](#) has a powerful message of social inclusion.
- **[IAN](#) - 9:51 min.**
 - TheCGBros Presents "Ian" by Mundoloco CGI Ian Foundation - He was born with cerebral palsy. All he wants is to make friends, although it seems impossible to achieve when discrimination and bullying keep him away from his beloved playground. However, this young boy is determined and won't give up easily.

- **My Hero Brother - Full feature film**

- “My Hero Brother is an amazing documentary! It’s an eye-opening film about disability and it’s also about what parents and siblings each go through. My Hero Brother is a great discussion starter.” *Sholly Weiser Yaldei Shluchei HaRebbe*
- [My Hero Brother](#) about a group of young Israeli adults with Down Syndrome who embark on a demanding trek through the Himalayas with their siblings. As they deal with physical and emotional challenges, unresolved conflicts come to the surface and heartwarming friendships develop. In Hebrew with English subtitles.

- **Life, Animated - Full feature film**

- [Life Animated](#) tells the remarkable story of Owen Susskind, an autistic boy who stopped speaking at age 3 and found a pathway to language and a framework for making sense of the world through Disney animated films. By interweaving classic Disney sequences with verité scenes from Owen’s life, the film explores how identification and empathy with characters like Simba, Jafar, and Ariel create a context for him to understand his feelings and interpret reality.

- **Front of the Class**

- [Front of the Class](#) is the triumphant story of Brad Cohen. As a child, Brad started making funny noises - all the time. He couldn’t control it. He was teased, misunderstood and punished for disrupting class. By the time he was diagnosed with Tourette syndrome, Brad had become disenchanted with school. He decided to become the kind of teacher he never had. Brad Cohen’s resilience and determination changed his life.

Inclusive Song: We All Belong

An uplifting and hopeful music video featuring 8th Day performing the Ruderman Chabad Inclusion Initiative’s anthem of inclusion [“We All Belong.”](#) Have it playing throughout the evening!

Inclusive Havdalah Planning Agenda Sample

Date: February 18, 2023 | **Time:** 7:30-9PM | **Location:** N/A | **Target Audience:**

7:30pm - 7:40pm

Acclimate and Snacks

- What kind of food? Include gluten-free, dairy-free, and nut-free.
- Who will prepare it?
- Decide if a sensory table is needed and who will run it throughout the program.

7:40pm - 8:00pm

Musical Havdalah

- Who will lead singing?
- Who will play and what instruments?
- Who will create besamim bags?
- Who will bring havdalah candle/grape juice?

8:00pm - 8:10pm

Evening Program or Activity Introduction

- Who will be the emcee for the program?
- Who will welcome everyone and introduce the emcee? Self Advocate?

8:10-8:25pm

Movie

- Interviewer (short 12 min film to set tone)

8:20pm - 8:45pm

DIY Havdalah Kits

- Need to order. How many?
- Quiet space?
- Who will lead craft and frame the inclusive explanation?
- [Print out cards that](#) explain it to go with each kit
- Bags to take kits home

8:45 - 8:55pm

Take The Pledge

- [Click Here for Pledge Cards](#)
- Who will Print pledge cards?

8:55pm - 9:00pm

Closing, Shavua Tov

- Who will close?